"2025 has been a ride and I have been forcing myself to slow down and reflect a little more than usual.

It's been a huge year of personal and business growth for me, Aussie Expat Home Loans and Urbane Finance.

At the start of the year, we were a team of 10. Today, we are close to 30. That growth still feels strange to say out loud.
Not because of the number itself, but because of what comes with it. More responsibility and people relying on decisions you make. More weight behind every choice and bigger numbers to hit.
But these are all things I have tried to embrace and grow into.

In May we did our first acquisition and brought another Mortgage broking group into Urbane Finance.
To date it has been one of the biggest decisions I have made in the business. Its definitley pushed me harder than I expected and taught me a lot very quickly about structures, leadership and partnerships.

But mainly its also reminded me how important it is to surround yourself with the right people if you want to build something that lasts.

Growth has a habit of exposing everything.
Processes that once worked suddenly break.
Gaps become obvious, and old habits show up under pressure.
All a reminder that if you want to scale and grow, you need to invest properly in systems, training, and people, rather than trying to carry everything yourself (sometimes easier said than done :)).

One of the harder lessons for me has been learning to let go. To trust others more. To stop being the bottleneck boss.
That is still very much a work in progress, but I am fortunate that I have brought in really good people around me who value the work and the journey and most importantly our clients.

Personally its been a year where I could have let work overwhelm me but I have also learned how to keep space for myself and not let the pressure really destroy my mindset.
Being able to self reflect and appreciate where I have come to is not an natural instinct for me but I have learned to stop every once in a while and realise taking time and energy for myself shouldn't be something I feel guilty about.
Realising that you are a better boss when you are at your best is an important lesson.

My two biggest thanks this year are to our clients at AEXPHL and Urbane.
Without your support and kind words about us we could never keep achieving the goals we set.

And also very importantly to my team.
They make everything possible and have consistently shown up and been superstars that make everything happen for our clients and partners.

2026 is shaping up to be an even bigger year, with huge plans for both Urbane and our Asia business which I look forward to sharing more of in the new year.

I hope everyone has a great Xmas and Holiday season and Happy New Year :)."
"Thank you Luke Pervan and Cilla Burgmann for having me on your pod today talking all things Expat and foreigner borrowing.
As well as peering into my crystal ball for interest rates on 2026
Property NXT Australia"
"Starting Urbane Finance in Melbourne was one of the scariest business decisions I've made.

There's no roadmap when you choose to build something from scratch, especially when you're not based there full time.
You put everything on the line — time, energy, and belief — hoping it will take shape the way you imagine.

But the truth is, it only works if you have the right people beside you. The ones who care about the clients, the work, and each other. The ones who turn a risky idea into something real.

I'm lucky to have that at Urbane. An incredible team who show up every day with purpose and pride. They've turned what started as a blank page into a thriving business that genuinely helps people.

Grateful for every single one of you. 🙏🙏🙏🙏"
"10 Years in Singapore 🇸🇬

Ten years. That one caught me off guard.

I came to Singapore at 28 as a trailing spouse, thinking I'd be here for maybe a year or two. I didn't have a plan. I just knew I wanted to make something of it.

That first year was rough. I spent my days on LinkedIn messaging other Aussies, trying to figure out the banking landscape and how people built careers here. It took me a full year to land a job… and less than one to lose it through retrenchment.

That was a hard moment — but also a turning point.

Not long after, I met Calvin Ng. He's the one who first said, "Why don't you start something yourself?" I didn't know what that meant then, but I said yes. And that yes changed everything.

From those early days working out of my bedroom, doing everything myself, it's grown into offices in Singapore and Hong Kong, and through Urbane Finance, a team in Melbourne. Nearly 30 people now.

It still blows my mind.

The funny thing is, all that networking I did in the beginning ended up shaping everything. Those first LinkedIn connections turned into clients, colleagues, and friends. Most of our business still comes through word of mouth.

When I'm having a rough day, I read our Google reviews. Every one is a reminder that this isn't just finance — it's helping people move forward in life. I still take every deal personally.

And one of my biggest lessons has been building my work family — my team is the reason we've come this far. And I learned you can't succeed in business without superstars around you.

So to Singapore, I say thank you.

You've given me chances I never imagined. You've pushed me, connected me, and taught me not to limit myself. You've given me lifelong friendships, let my passion for music back in my life, and a deep appreciation for the community I live in and serve (which I love exploring in our podcast The Aussie Expat Podcast).

You've been home in more ways than one.

Here's to the next Singapore chapter — and to saying yes when opportunity knocks. 🙏🏻"
"I want to thank Cilla Burgmann for sharing her story as it's one that is unconventional but at the same time a great example of how we often have to pivot and move and grow over our time overseas, and that often there is no "conventional" way when different opportunities present themselves.

We had a great chat and I really love your outlook Cilla :-)."
"As Expats we go on a journey each year we are away so it's was really fun to capture Jonas Groom at a relatively early period of his journey and see his perspective of living in Asia and how Hong Kong has changed even in the short time he has been there.

He's also a polyglot with some great stories and a cult following on insta showing his (sometimes hilarious) journey learning Cantonese. 悉尼 😅

Hope you all enjoy and please like and subscribe to The Aussie Expat Podcast"
"If you want to know why Joseph Pullos is one of the best in the game for Expats and property you will see why in our latest #theaussieexpat pod.

And great to share another story of an expat business owner taking a chance on themselves.

A great watch for anyone who wants to know about what buyers advocates look for when searching for quality properties and what it takes to build a client centric business from the ground up."
One of my favourite stories to hear and congrats Amy Bell for your 10 year celebrations today for the Meat Club. Onwards and upwards ! 😎😎
"I'm looking for an ops expert who can work as part of our leadership team and take our business operations from great to best in class.

If you know anyone who might be interested pls pass them my details :-)."
"Its been really amazing to watch Matt Hooper go through this experience and I really want to thank him for being so open and humble about it and for sharing with us, both the ups and the downs.
It's also a great snapshot of information for anyone else considering going down this road in their lives."
"While this role is in Melbourne, its a chance to work directly with me and support the greatest client base of any broker :).
I'm looking for someone with strong credit skills, but more importantly an attitude to make sure every single client knows that we have their back.

If this sounds like you or you know anyone who may be suitable I'd be very keen to have a chat.

https://lnkd.in/dPSNAT3e"
Being able to get involved with AISHK has been a real highlight for me this year and a big thanks to you Brigitte McNamara for all the work you've done and continue to do to foster such a great community of students and people :-).
"I am a bit of a private person and am used to being on the other side of the interview chair.
So this episode was a little awkward for me to talk so much about myself and my journey.

I hope some of you find it interesting or helpful. :-)"
Great event to attend for anyone wanting learn the best tax tips when managing and structuring your property purchases overseas.
My fave AustCham Singapore event every year (as I say in a little cameo at the end 😅)
"Excited for our first episode to launch and a big thanks to Jamie Burgmann for being brave enough to kick it off and share his story.

We have some really interesting episodes coming out over the next couple of months so stay tuned :)."
"Thanks to all of our clients and friends who came down for our very soft launch event :).
Our first episode with Jamie Burgmann will be up this week, and we can't wait for you to hear some of the stories we have recorded so far."
"Going to be a great event for anyone interested in learning about property and investment diversification.

Property NXT - Guiding Aussie Expats globally to their next Australian investment."
"I am really excited to welcome Aron Underwood and the team to Urbane.
We have some big goals for our Australian business and I am really excited to see it grow under Aron's leadership and to be able to provide our clients an amazing experience no matter whether they are overseas or back home.

2025 is going to be a huge year!"
"Exciting times ahead. Look forward to sharing more stories and advice together as we explore what it really means to be an Aussie expat.
Stay tuned for more …

Tristan Perry FCA Jamie Burgmann"
"I've been down in Melbourne this week doing a lot of work on our business here.
It's been nice to know I've had good support back home managing my emails while I've been in meetings.

TGIF :-)."
Join Shaun Rattray and Adam Norton as they discuss why Melbourne seems to be the hot topic for 2025.
Excited to share this new series with Tristan Perry FCA coming to you over the next couple of months where we break down the most common tax questions for Aussie Expats.
Great couple of days in Brisbane and thanks for Bankwest for their support of us and the expat community 🙏🙏
💵 Join Shaun Rattray and Matthew Jones as they break down all the important take aways from the latest govt budget as well as some covering off expat financial tips and traps.
Great weekend in HK launching our new partnership with the HK Dragon's AFL club. Going to be a fun year ahead!
Bloomberg data shows traders who bet on interest rates were expecting a 67 per cent chance of a rate cut in February before Wednesday's data was released, and are now predicting a 74 per cent chance of a 0.25-percentage-point cut at the Reserve Bank's first meeting of the year.
"Big thanks to Luke from Property NXT for sharing some great insights into the Australian commercial property market in this episode of our Aussie Property Pulse.

I also share my expertise on the financing side, diving into how banks approach commercial property loans differently. That's why we started Aussie Property Pulse – to bring expert knowledge directly to our clients and help you make informed decisions. I hope you enjoy this edition!"
We are #hiring. Know anyone who might be interested?
"Thanks Luke Pervan and Cilla Burgmann for hosting such as great Property NXT ""South-East Queensland"" event last night. It was a pleasure to share insights on property financing for Australian expats and non-residents, and to tackle one of the most frequently asked questions I get from clients—where are interest rates heading?

A brilliant evening filled with valuable discussions and great company—catching up with existing clients and meeting new faces."
"New episode of Aussie Property Pulse is out!
After a bit of a detour (thanks to jet lag, some fast-moving market changes and my video skills!), I'm back with the long-awaited retake of my conversation with Hamish Mcintosh from One Haven Property. We dive deep into what's been happening in Melbourne's property market and why Melbourne is back on the radar for many of our clients.

Catch the full conversation on our YouTube channel – and if you're interested in monthly updates like this, feel free to subscribe here:

https://lnkd.in/gtACsV_B

Thanks for your patience and support. Looking forward to hearing your thoughts on this one!"
"Really great day at the AustCham Hong Kong Melbourne Cup lunch.

Great to be there with my team and business partners, and to be made to awkwardly walk down the fashions on the field run way 🚶

Shaun Rattray Matthew Jones Andre Mudigdo M.Comm CFP® CWM® Anna Huo, CFA Naven Nand Aussie Expat Home Loans"
The case for a Feb rate cut keeps getting more likely with inflation falling below 3% for the first time in 3 years.
"Fun morning shooting the latest property pulse with Luke Pervan and Cilla Burgmann from Property NXT - in this episode we help to demystify commercial property.

Stay tuned 😎"
"The Victorian Government just announced off-the-plan stamp duty concessions for anyone considering buying an apartment, unit, or townhouse in Victoria. There are significant savings on offer (click the link to see the government examples), but the concession is only available for the next 12 months.

If you're planning to take advantage of this opportunity and need the best property financing deals, my team is here to help.

Check out the details below to see how you might benefit. 👇"
"Last month I recorded our latest property podcast with Hamish Mcintosh
Fast forward to now - life threw in some jet lag and the market shifted much more quickly than expected, and by the time it was ready, it didn't feel relevant anymore.
I also realised I have a bit to learn about filming effectively in person :).

The good news is I am seeing Hamish again in a couple of weeks to re-film our episode with more current info.

And we have a new series coming out in the next couple of months that will start to discuss other important Expat related topics.

Thanks for sticking with me and I look forward to bringing you more content soon :)."
"One of the most common questions I get is: How much #stampduty will I need to pay on my property?

No worries, we have a Stamp Duty Calculator on the Aussie Expat Home Loans website that makes it easy to work out what you'll need to pay.

If you're like me and want to keep posts like this with useful tools handy, here's what I do: leave a comment on this post so it sticks around in your feed for when you need it later. You can also save the post if you prefer! Or just give me a call – I'm always happy to help!"
"There have been some posts floating around in different groups and online the last couple of weeks stating that banks are pulling out of the Expat lending space and that doom and gloom is upon us for overseas borrowers, and so I just wanted to share my thoughts and hopefully provide some clarity and context to our Expat community.

As of today , the only bank that has specifically pulled out of the Expat lending space is Macquarie Bank. They have exited this market as they had very low volumes of applications due to some restrictive policy conditions that just didn't make them competitive. It would have been over a year since we last used them for Expat borrowers as there are other banks now that have the same policy niches they had without some of the frustrating processes attached, such as a lack of offset facility and requirement to have a registered POA established.

There are two other lenders that we used widely for Expat borrowers that are also winding down. I won't name them for now as some of the info may not be available to the market, but one is closing for all broker applications due to a large technology upgrade that will impact all of their core systems. This closure is temporary and they will come back to market once it is complete.
The other recently merged with another bank and they are in the process of integrating both previous brands into a new brand, and so they are winding down the previous brand they were working under.
Both of these exits have nothing to do with Expat lending and impact all borrowers, not just those overseas. Yes, we will lose them as options in the short term but come next year we hope to be able to work with them again.

On the flip side, in the last few months we have had two banks completely overhaul their Expat policy for the better, and specifically come to us saying they are after Expat applicants as they can see the value in us as borrowers and customers.

The nature of the market for us is some banks come, some banks go.
But we still have plenty of options available and there has been absolutely no ""industry talk"" of all Expat borrowers not being able to borrow soon.

If anyone wants to discuss we are always available to review your options.
Can email the team on enquiry@aexphl.com or feel free to Whatsapp me on +65 8479 3873

Cute photo of my dog because its Monday :-)

Aussie Expat Home Loans
cc Shaun Rattray Charu Kumar Paul Truong"
Will always be thankful for the support of AustCham Singapore 🙏🙏🙏
"It was exciting to be able to share some of our story with Expat Living last week and that we are now able to serve our clients regionally in Hong Kong and also when they finish their Expat journey and return home.

When I started the business over 6 years ago I would never have thought we would be able to grow as organically and quickly as we have but it's all thanks to the support of our amazing clients and my amazing team.

Shaun Rattray Paul Truong Kuldeep Singh Charu Kumar"
"It's official once the signage is up :-)

Paul Truong Urbane Finance Kuldeep Singh"
"Happy to be in Melbourne this week and to film the latest property pulse with Hamish Mcintosh at OneHaven.

Is Melbourne a sleeper city ?
Tune in next week to find out our thoughts …"
"I've been bullish on Brisbane for a while due to the long term demographic shift of our aging population, the relative unaffordability of Sydney and the huge amount of investment and jobs being created. As well as the general lifestyle appeal and infrastructure investment.

The Olympics will help drive some of the growth but all the fundamentals are there for Brisbane and the whole of SE Qld to do well not just in the next 10 years but beyond."
"Brisbane is another interesting, hot market for clients at the moment. With the influx of buyers from out of state increasing competition for buyers, having pre-approvals set up to make a quick offer is even more crucial.

For this month's Property Pulse I spoke with Brad Reece who shared CapitalVue's insights from Queensland."
"Really great AustCham Singapore event on Friday for the Annual President's award lunch.

Managed to grab a couple of pictures in between the drinks and just wanted to give my thanks to Emma Humann for all of her support to me and the team at Aussie Expat Home Loans during her time as Exec Director, and for just being an overall great human being :-).

She has been an exceptional advocate for Aussie businesses in Singapore and the chamber has been run incredibly well under her leadership.
Will be sorely missed as the Chamber ED but thankfully will still be around in SG for some time to come.

And congrats to Erica Marcellan and the Austcham team for another fabulous event.

cc Melissa Montgomery :-)"
"I'm delighted to share some major news from a large Aussie lender.

This news is a game-changer for our expat community, and we couldn't be happier to tell you about the new loan policies that make it easier for expats to secure a mortgage to buy property back home.

Feel free to give me a message if you want to review your options.
+65 8479 3873.
enquiry@aexphl.com"
For anyone in Melbourne, if you happen to have an opportunity for someone with experience in Project Management, Business Management or Workforce Transformations (or if you'd just like to have a chat about rowing), give Brent Lucadou-Wells a message. You'd be lucky to have him!
"I am very priviliged to work with some of the best in the business when it comes to property and Expat financial advice. This year I really wanted to bring some of that knowledge to you on a regular bais, to help keep Expats up to date with what is happening in the market, and keep front of mind what we need to be thinking about while we are away and what we need to do before we return.

Our first series is our Aussie Property Pulse, a monthly series where I pick the brains of our property partners about what is happening in the Aussie property market.
Our first guest is Hamish Mcintosh, founder of One Haven Property.
Check it out on the link below :-)."
"Excited to be speaking at Navigate the 2024 Aussie Budget: Key Updates Every Expat Must Know!

If you're keen to hear how the upcoming budget may affect you, be sure to register below."
"🌟 I am absolutely delighted to welcome Shaun Rattray as our new Mortgage Broker in our Hong Kong office.

Shaun is a familiar face in the Australian expat community and a master of complex loan structuring.

His expertise will enhance our ability to serve Australian expats in Hong Kong seeking property financing for their Australian dream.

Welcome to the team Shaun!

#NewHire #AussieExpat #HomeLoans"
"🥳 I am extremely proud of my team on the opening of our new office in Hong Kong! 🎉

I founded Aussie Expat Home Loans six and a half years ago with the goal of helping my fellow Aussies to find dream homes and property investments in Australia.

I wanted to create a better mortgage broking experience and I'm thrilled that we've received so many 5-star reviews from clients who appreciate our ‘white glove’ approach.

I will continue to be based in our Singapore office and will visit Hong Kong regularly, but stay tuned, I have more exciting news to share next week about our expansion! 🎉

Thank you to our valued clients for your support and for recommending us to your friends. We sincerely appreciate it!"
"The impact of interest rate increases since the low fixed interest rates offered during pandemic, could have a significant impact on people with fixed rate Australian home loans expiring in 2024.

Message me here, or call me on +65 6653 6230 and I'd be happy to talk about how we can secure you the best non-resident, Aussie expat home loan under the new interest rate environment.

enquiry@aexphl.com

#Refinancing #FixedRateLoans"""
"Rental vacancy rates are predicted to remain tight in most major capitals in Australia. Does this pose a buying opportunity for Aussie expats looking for property investments?

Our latest post looks at the rental market and what is driving it: “Why rents in Australia are expected to keep rising.”

Message or call me on +65 6653 6230 to discuss how we can secure you the best #nonresident, #Aussie #expat #mortgage.

enquiry@aexphl.com"
I am looking to hire. If you know anyone who may be suitable please ask them to send me a message. :-)
"Comments like this is why we love doing what we do!

Do you need help securing a loan? Give us a call today!
0403 961 627"
I'm hiring - if you know anyone suitable please feel free to refer them through to me :).
First home buyer activity jump 15.8% month on month.
"Why interest rates were raised?

#interestrates #finance #mortage"
The refinancing activity snowball keeps going. Contact us if you want to have a look at your options.